

You are the bottleneck.

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Executive Summary

Founders who handle every problem personally become the ceiling of their business. The solution is hiring better managers and coaching your team — not running more ads or closing more sales.

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The Bottleneck Realization 0:00

- Most operators underestimate this problem — until they hit a wall
 - At that point they discover they are the ceiling of their own company
- Personal example: ~10 employees, a few hundred thousand dollars a month in revenue
 - Every issue, problem, and escalation came directly to him
 - His realization: "This is not sustainable."
- If you are the only one solving problems in your business, you are the bottleneck

The Root Cause: Not Leading, Just Doing 0:22

- It took a long time to understand what was actually going wrong
- The real failure was in three areas:
 - Not leading and coaching the team
 - Not properly managing them
 - Not properly communicating with them
- Instead of managing, he was simply doing his team's jobs whenever something went wrong
- The deeper problem: he hadn't hired the next level of talent

The Fix: Hire Up and Get Out of the Way 0:43

- If you're the only person who can solve your business's problems, your team isn't good enough yet
- The required action: hire managers — people who are **better than you** at specific roles

"No amount of ads or sales will ever help you break free from that."

- Growth levers like advertising and sales cannot solve a leadership/talent gap
- Without the right people in place, you will remain the bottleneck indefinitely